Josh Beard

Platform Engineering | Software Delivery | DevOps Leadership

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Engineering manager and platform engineer focused on software delivery, developer experience, and the platforms teams use to build and deploy reliable services. I lead platform strategy as a hands-on manager, shaping the systems, tooling, and standards that connect development workflows to production. My work centers on coherent platforms, reduced toil, and enabling engineers to own the services they build.

Experience

DevOps Engineering Manager at Live Oak Bank

September 2022 - Present

Previously:

- Staff DevOps Engineer — February 2025 - February 2026
- Senior DevOps Engineer — September 2022 - February 2025

- Lead platform strategy and DevOps AI roadmap for a team supporting multiple engineering groups, aligning delivery automation, engineering standards, and platform adoption with business and compliance requirements.
- Drive cross-team standardization of tooling and delivery practices, reducing per-team pipeline variance and improving time-to-production across the engineering org.
- Architect CI/CD and platform infrastructure that scales across teams while maintaining auditability and governance controls for a regulated banking environment.
- Built a release orchestration tool in Go that reduced manual release steps and improved rollback safety across production deployments.
- Developed and open-sourced a Terraform provider and Go API client for a third-party integration, enabling self-service infrastructure for downstream teams.
- Established observability practices for CI/CD pipelines, giving engineering leadership visibility into delivery performance for the first time.

Key technology: *AWS, CI/CD, Claude, Cursor, DataDog, Devcontainers, Docker, GitLab, GitOps, Go, Golang, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Developer AI Tooling, Platform Engineering, Python, Shell, Terraform, Traefik*

Lead DevSecOps Engineer at Ventera, Inc (US Geological Survey)

June 2022 - April 2023

- Contracted to USGS Water Resources Mission Area to modernize critical national water data services used by researchers and the public.

- Built AWS infrastructure and CI/CD pipelines for serverless Python applications and static websites, reducing deployment time and operational overhead.
- Integrated automated security scanning and compliance checks into CI/CD pipelines, reducing manual review burden on development teams.

Key technology: *AWS, CloudFormation, GitLab, Python*

Lead DevOps Engineer at Apogee Engineering, LLC (US Geological Survey)

September 2015 - May 2022

Previously:

- Senior DevOps Engineer — September 2015 - December 2019

- Owned platform architecture and infrastructure for dozens of USGS scientific data products serving millions of public users.
- Led migration of 200+ projects from legacy CI/CD systems to GitLab, standardizing delivery practices across a large multi-team organization.
- Deployed configuration management at scale using Puppet and Ansible across hundreds of Linux systems, eliminating configuration drift and reducing incident response time.
- Migrated dozens of applications from on-premise to AWS using Docker, cutting infrastructure costs and enabling teams to scale workloads independently.
- Mentored engineers and scientists in DevOps practices, enabling teams to own and operate their own infrastructure without platform team dependency.

Key technology: *AWS, CI/CD, GitLab, Docker, Terraform, Ansible, Platform Engineering, GitOps, Puppet, Python, Nginx, Traefik*

Professional Services Engineer at Puppet Inc.

September 2013 - April 2015

- Delivered consulting and hands-on training on Puppet and DevOps practices to enterprise clients across multiple industries.
- Developed reusable Puppet modules and automation tooling adopted by client teams after engagements closed.
- Consistently earned strong client feedback for practical, no-nonsense technical guidance.

Key technology: *Puppet, Linux, Ruby, Git, Shell*

Linux/Unix Systems Administrator at Douglas School District

January 2010 - September 2013

- Managed Linux/Unix infrastructure and server operations for a K-12 district environment.

- Introduced system automation and monitoring, reducing manual maintenance toil and improving uptime.
- Provided technical support and maintained core network services.

Key technology: *Linux, Unix, Puppet, Nginx, MySQL, KVM, PHP*

Skills & Expertise

Core Competencies

- Platform Engineering & Developer Experience
- Engineering Leadership & Team Enablement
- Release Management & Automation
- CI/CD Architecture & Pipeline Design
- Infrastructure as Code & Configuration Management
- DevSecOps & Compliance Automation

Infrastructure & CI/CD

- GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions
- Terraform, CloudFormation, CDK
- Puppet, Ansible
- Nginx, HAProxy, Traefik
- PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Observability

- DataDog, Prometheus
- Elasticsearch, Graylog
- PagerDuty
- Sensu

Platforms & Technologies

- AWS Cloud Services
- Docker, Kubernetes
- Linux/Unix (RHEL, Ubuntu, Debian, Alpine, FreeBSD)
- Virtualization (Proxmox, LXC, Vagrant, KVM, vSphere)
- Security Scanning & Vulnerability Management

Programming Languages

- Go
- Python
- Shell/Bash
- Ruby
- YAML, JSON, HCL
- PHP

Security & Compliance

- Code Analysis & Security Scanning
- Compliance Automation
- Security Policy as Code